

SPORTSUNIVERSE

Current Functionality Handbook

A practical guide to what the platform does today, who can use each capability, and how the major workflows operate.

Prepared 21 July 2026 · Web and shared mobile API · Production-oriented edition

DOCUMENT GUIDE

Contents and scope

This handbook describes functionality implemented in the current SportsUniverse codebase. “Implemented” means the application workflow exists; external services still require valid production configuration and running infrastructure.

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Important: payment processing, AI visual review, email, push, live signalling, queues, Redis, PostgreSQL, media processing and object/local storage depend on their production services and environment values.

1 · FOUNDATION

Platform overview and roles

SportsUniverse is a sports-first social, talent, opportunity and commercial platform. The Laravel backend serves the Inertia/Vue web application and versioned APIs used by web and mobile clients.

Supported account roles

AthleteFanCoachRefereeLinesmanScoutAgentClubAcademyBusinessSponsorAdminSystem adminSuper admin

ROLE FAMILY

CURRENT USE

Athletes and sporting professionals

Public identity, sporting details, career history, achievements, statistics, uploads, live content, analytics and applications.

Fans

Interest-based feed, following, engagement, discovery, messaging and saved content.

Clubs, academies and scouts

Public club presence, opportunities, shortlists, comparisons, notes, invitations, staff and recruitment pipeline.

Businesses and sponsors

Sponsorship campaigns, promoted posts, targeting, PayFast checkout and campaign metrics.

Administrators

Filament administration, reports, content moderation, AI suggestions, appeals, settings and operational oversight.

Responsive delivery

The web interface is responsive for desktop and mobile browsers. Versioned APIs

provide the same core data and business rules for a mobile client, including authentication, feeds, profiles, messaging, notifications and media.

2 . ACCESS

Authentication and account security

Registration and onboarding

- Account registration with availability checks.
- Role selection and role-specific onboarding.
- Email verification and resend limits.
- Google, Facebook, Apple and Microsoft social login hooks.

Account recovery

- Forgot-password and signed reset flow.
- Session-expired screen.
- Web and API logout.
- Account-deletion request and cancellation APIs.

Session and device controls

Users can view recent sessions, identify the current session, revoke individual sessions, or sign out other devices. Login history is converted into readable device information.

Register or sign in

→

Verify email

→

Complete role onboarding

→

Access authenticated tools

Security protections currently present

- CSRF protection for state-changing web actions.
- Sanctum authentication for APIs.
- Role checks and model policies.
- Signed download and verification links.
- Rate limits for authentication, uploads, reports, messages and payment callbacks.
- Content Security Policy, secure focus states and restricted PayF

ast form destinations.

3 . IDENTITY

Profiles and sporting identity

Profiles combine general identity with role-specific sporting or organisational details. Public profiles use readable slugs such as /@profile-name.

CAPABILITY

HOW IT WORKS

General profile

Name, biography, location, profile image, cover image, visibility and completeness.

Athlete profile

Sport, position/taxonomy, sporting details and performance identity.

Professional profile

Professional role information for coaches, scouts, agents and officials.

Organisation profile

Club, academy, sponsor or business identity.

Career

Career history, achievements and season statistics can be added and removed.

Connections

Follower and following lists, counts, follow state and public profile discovery.

Users can save profiles and profile searches. Public athlete and club pages expose relevant posts, opportunities, career information and social actions while respecting privacy and blocking rules.

4 . CORE EXPERIENCE

Feed and recommendation engine

For You

The For You feed selects published, public, approved sports content. It uses pre computed recommendation IDs when available and falls back to candidate retrieval and live ranking. Ranking considers interests, content metadata, engagement and freshness; diversification reduces repetition. Fan sport preferences, location, sport and position can narrow candidates.

Following

The Following feed contains normal posts from followed accounts and the viewer's own posts, ordered newest first. Stories are separated into the Stories row instead of being repeated as ordinary feed cards.

Scrolling and repetition

- Cursor pagination loads a small page at a time; it never retrieves the full database.

- Client-side duplicate keys prevent repeated items on the same scrolling session.

- Not-interested preferences remove a post, creator, sport or similar topic from future candidate sets.

- Impression, skip, replay, watch duration and completion signals improve subsequent recommendations.

Eligible candidates

→ Preferences and safety

→ Rank

→ Diversify

→ Sponsored placement

→ Cursor page

Scale design: feed endpoints operate on indexed candidate subsets and cursor pages. The five-million-post dataset is intended for performance testing, not bulk delivery to the browser.

5 . PUBLISHING

Posts, uploads and media

Supported publishing formats

- MP4, MOV and WebM video.
- JPG, PNG and WebP images.
- Up to ten pictures in a carousel, with a selectable cover.
- A combined video-and-picture carousel where supplied.

Creator workflow

Select or capture

→ Trim and improve

→ Add sports metadata

→ Upload

→ Process and moderate

→ Publish

EDITOR

CURRENT BEHAVIOR

Video trim

Select start point and a post length up to 60 seconds. Story videos are capped at 30 seconds.

Visual adjustments

Brightness, contrast, colour saturation, rotation, output width and compression quality.

Sports metadata

Sport, country, league, team, competition, content type, language, skills/topics

and location.

Audience

Everyone, followers or only the creator for normal posts. Stories are follower-only unless promoted.

Draft resilience

Browser IndexedDB preserves unfinished media and metadata. Upload progress and reconnect guidance are shown.

Processing

Background workers trim/transcode video, create thumbnails and renditions, optimise media, moderate and publish when ready.

Creators can edit captions, hashtags, location, cover and visibility; publish drafts; list their posts, likes, favourites and reposts; or delete content they own.

6 · EPHEMERAL CONTENT

Stories

- A Story can contain video or pictures.
- Video length cannot exceed 30 seconds; the limit is enforced in the editor, API and background finalisation.
- The lifetime begins when processing completes and the Story becomes published.
- Every Story expires exactly 24 hours after publication.
- Organic Stories are visible to the creator and followers only.

Placement

SURFACE

STORY BEHAVIOR

For You

Shows “Your Story” for creating or viewing the creator’s own active Story. Organic follower Stories do not appear as regular For You posts.

Following

Shows the dedicated horizontal Story circles for followed creators. Organic Stories are not duplicated in the normal Following post list.

Promoted placement

An approved, paid Story promotion can enter the normal For You feed for matching non-followers, but promotion never extends the 24-hour expiry.

Viewer

Tapping a circle opens a full-screen viewer. Images progress after six seconds; videos progress when playback ends. Viewers can move backward or forward, close the viewer, see remaining lifetime and use a sponsored call to action.

7 · COMMUNITY

Engagement and social graph

Post engagement

- Like and unlike.
- Save and unsave.
- Comment and reply.
- Like comments.
- Share externally or repost internally.
- View counts using watch duration and completion.

Relationship actions

- Follow and unfollow profiles.
- Follow-back from notifications.
- Message mutual connections.
- Save profiles.
- Block and unblock users.
- Report posts, messages or profiles where supported.

Engagement mutations are designed as idempotent toggles where appropriate. Counts are returned after each action so web and mobile interfaces can update immediately.

8 · FIND PEOPLE AND CONTENT

Discovery and search

- Unified search across people and posts.
- Search by term, creator, hashtag, sport and location metadata.
- Saved searches and search-history clearing.
- Saved profiles.
- Women in Sports hub for profiles, stories and opportunities.
- Recommended and trending accounts based on recent views and weighted engagement.
- Feed links for sport, position and location.

Content intelligence

Posts store structured sport, country, league, team, competition, content type, language, skills, detected labels and topic weights. These features distinguish related areas—for example English football from South African football—rather than treating every football post as identical.

9 . COMMUNICATION

Messaging and notifications

Messaging

A first message to a non-mutual connection is sent as a request. Requests can be accepted or declined; accepted relationships open conversations. Conversations support read state, archive/unarchive, mute, typing state, reporting, editing/deleting owned messages and blocking.

Notifications

Notifications are grouped by date and category, include unread counts and allow individual deletion or “mark all read.” Preference controls cover messages, requests, opportunities, followers, engagement, moderation, profile views and email digest.

- Database notifications are the durable source.
- Realtime events update the open interface.
- Expo push jobs support mobile notifications when configured.
- Moderation notifications include AI flags, review results and appeal actions.

10 . BROADCAST

Live streaming

Authenticated users can create live rooms; viewers can discover active streams, join, exchange signalling data, send live messages and receive lifecycle updates.

CAPABILITY

CURRENT OPERATION

Host lifecycle

Create, heartbeat and explicitly end a stream.

Viewer lifecycle

Open a live room, join and refresh room state.

Realtime

WebRTC-style signalling and Reverb-backed realtime services.

Chat

Messages are posted to the live room and merged without duplicate IDs.

Capacity

Membership limits expose tiered live-audience capacity; actual large-event infrastructure must be sized accordingly.

11 . CAREERS

Opportunities and applications

Opportunity owners

- Create, edit, publish, cancel and delete opportunities.
- Attach sport, role, location, deadline and requirements.
- View applicants and supporting material.
- Move applications through submitted, reviewing, shortlisted, accepted or rejected states.

Applicants

- Browse and view opportunities.
- Save or unsave opportunities.

- Apply with cover letter, résumé and requirement documents.
- Track status and reviewer notes.
- Withdraw an application.

Status history creates a visible application timeline and supports notifications when an organiser changes an application.

12 · RECRUITMENT OPERATIONS

Club workspace

Eligible club, academy and scout users receive a recruitment workspace separate from the public club page.

Talent management

- Create shortlists.
- Add athletes.
- Write private notes.
- Compare athletes.
- Send invitations.

Team operations

- Manage staff access.
- Update or remove staff.
- Review recruitment pipeline.
- Move applications between stages.
- Update club workspace information.

13 · COMMERCIAL GROWTH

Advertising and sponsorship

Campaign types

TYPE

GOALS

Post or Story promotion

Views, followers, website visits or awareness.

Sponsorship campaign

Applications, website visits or awareness without requiring an existing post.

Creation flow

Preview post

→

Choose goal

→

Audience and budget

→

Review

→

PayFast

→

Admin review

The post selector displays video or image previews before selection. Targeting supports sport, gender, province and age range. Daily budget and duration generate estimated reach and a total.

Delivery controls

- Only active, paid and approved campaigns are eligible.
- Campaign dates, remaining budget, daily pacing and per-viewer frequency caps are enforced.
- Blocked users and not-interested preferences remain excluded.
- Audience metadata is matched before insertion.
- A promoted post is not duplicated on the same page.
- Impressions, clicks, video views, profile visits, follows, reach and spend are tracked by delivery.

PayFast

Campaign and membership checkouts generate signed browser POST forms. Return, cancellation and ITN routes are separate. ITNs validate source, signature, merchant, amount and PayFast server confirmation before changing payment or campaign state.

Sandbox rule: PayFast default sandbox Merchant ID 10000100 and Key 46f0cd694581a

must use an empty passphrase. Live mode requires the exact live account credentials and matching passphrase.

14 · PACKAGES

Membership packages

PLAN

CURRENT POSITIONING

INDICATIVE LIMITS

Free

Complete core sporting profile and community experience.

1,000 live viewers, 5 GB storage, one workspace seat, 30-day analytics.

Pro

Professional growth for athletes, coaches, scouts and creators.

10,000 live viewers, 50 GB, three seats, 365-day analytics and discovery tools.

Elite

Club, academy, agency, sponsor and event operations.

100,000 live viewers, 500 GB, 15 seats, extended analytics and branded operations.

- Monthly or annual billing; annual pricing represents the configured annual total.

- Paid checkout uses PayFast.

- Free downgrade is scheduled at the end of the current paid period.

- Profile, posts, followers and opportunities remain intact when plans change.

- Entitlements are resolved from the current subscription and plan limits.

Production requirement: the Free, Pro and Elite cards require SubscriptionPlanSeeder. The deployment workflow now includes this seed step; an empty-state warning appears if records are missing.

15 · MEASUREMENT

Analytics

Creator analytics

- Seven, 30 and 90-day periods.

- Video and profile views.

- Likes, comments, shares and saves.

- Engagement rate and interaction totals.

- Follower and lifetime totals.

- Content and audience performance breakdowns where data exists.

Campaign analytics

Campaign dashboards expose budget, status, impressions, unique reach, clicks, click rate, video views, profile visits, follows and spend.

Admin analytics

Administrative APIs provide platform-level analytics. Subscription analytics is restricted to system-admin and super-admin roles.

16 · TRUST AND RELEVANCE

Moderation and appeals

General moderation

- Users can report supported content with a reason and details.

- Admins review open reports, pending/flagged media and flagged posts.

- Actions can approve, flag, hide, reject or restore according to the content type.

- Every administrator decision is written to a moderation audit log.

Sports-relevance vision engine

A separate Python service samples eight frames across a video or reviews up to ten post images. A CLIP vision model compares the visuals with sports and non-sports concepts, then returns a sports-relevance score and explanation.

Sample visuals

→ Vision score

→ Threshold

→ Keep or flag

→ Human decision

- Low-scoring published content becomes flagged and leaves public feeds.
- The recommendation is “review for removal”; the engine never permanently deletes content.
- Admins see all AI suggestions, score, reason, creator and media.

Creator appeal

The creator receives a moderation notification and can send a message explaining why the content is sports-related. Duplicate pending appeals are blocked. Admins see the appeal alongside the AI evidence and can restore the post or uphold removal. The result is sent back to the creator and audited.

17 · ADMINISTRATION

Administrative control

Active admin, system-admin and super-admin accounts can enter the Filament panel. Higher-risk configuration is further restricted to system-admin or super-admin.

AREA CONTROLS

Users and organisations

Status, verification and operational review.

Media and videos

Metadata, moderation status, AI score/reason, approve, publish, hide or reject.

Reports and appeals

Triage, assign, resolve, dismiss, restore or uphold removal.

Campaigns

Payment state, pending review, activate/reject and campaign settings.

Feed

Ranking behavior, page size, fan sports and boost settings.

Membership

Subscription analytics for system ownership roles.

A repeatable production-access seeder can create separate super-admin, athlete and sponsor accounts with one-time generated passwords without committing secrets.

18 · MOBILE

Mobile and installation

- Responsive layouts, bottom navigation behavior and touch-friendly actions.
- Camera capture and mobile media selection from upload.
- Versioned Sanctum API for mobile authentication and platform features.
- Mobile configuration endpoint with supported/current version details.
- iOS Universal Links and Android App Links association files.
- Mobile download page with iOS, Android and direct-download configuration.
- Expo push-token subscription endpoints and queued push delivery.
- Service-worker hooks for offline upload-draft recovery and resume messaging.

Shared rules: feed visibility, Story expiry, moderation, campaign eligibility and access policies are enforced server-side, so mobile and web clients receive the same business behavior.

19 · SCALE

Data scale and production operations

Large feed dataset

The mass-feed generator can create up to five million deterministic PostgreSQL posts across configured sports, reusing licensed sports images and sampled source videos. It inserts in batches, creates topic records and resumes based on deterministic IDs.

- Command: `php artisan feed:seed-mass-posts --count=5000000 --batch=100000`.

- The operation is idempotent for the deterministic mass-feed ID range.

- The dedicated automatic production workflow was intentionally removed; production import can be handled through DBeaver as requested.

Runtime architecture

COMPONENT

PURPOSE

PostgreSQL

Primary relational store, feed indexes, cursor queries and large dataset operations.

Redis

Cache, queues, counters and realtime support when enabled.

Queue workers

Media processing, analysis, notifications and background jobs.

FFmpeg/FFprobe

Video trim, probing, thumbnail creation and renditions.

Reverb

Realtime application events and live features.

OpenSearch

Optional scalable discovery/search integration.

Nginx and PHP-FPM

Production web delivery and PHP execution.

20 · READINESS

Current operational dependencies

FEATURE

REQUIRED PRODUCTION SETUP

PayFast

Correct sandbox or live Merchant ID, Key and matching passphrase; HTTPS public callback URLs; refreshed Laravel config cache.

Membership cards

Subscription-plan migration and SubscriptionPlanSeeder.

Sports visual moderation

Python moderation container, reachable analysis URL, matching service token and queue worker.

Uploads

Writable storage, storage link, FFmpeg/FFprobe, queue worker and suitable PHP/Nginx limits.

Email

Working SMTP credentials and verified sender.

Push

Expo/mobile configuration and registered device tokens.

Realtime/live

Reverb service, secure public host and signalling-compatible network setup.

Large feed

PostgreSQL capacity, licensed source media, monitoring and deliberate DBeaver or CLI import.

Suggested production verification

- 1 Run migrations and required deterministic seeders.
- 2 Clear and rebuild configuration caches.
- 3 Confirm queue and Reverb services are active.
- 4 Verify ``/up``, ``/feed``, ``/following``, ``/membership`` and ``/admin`` for the correct roles.
- 5 Test a sandbox PayFast transaction and confirm the ITN updates p

ayment state.

6

Upload one image, normal video and Story; confirm processing and expiry fields.

7

Submit one AI moderation appeal and complete the admin decision. This handbook reflects the repository state on 21 July 2026. It is a functional guide, not a promise that every external provider is enabled in every environment.